

March

25

Also on this day

1306 Robert the Bruce was crowned king when Scotland regained its independence from English rule.

1655 Using his telescope, Dutch astronomer Christiaan Huygens spotted Titan, Saturn's largest moon.

1807 The Slave Trade Act became law, ending the trade of enslaved people throughout the British Empire.

Selma march

After police violence ended previous attempts, Black civil rights activist Martin Luther King, Jr. marched 87 km (54 miles) from Selma to Montgomery in Alabama, USA, joined by nearly 25,000 supporters. They were protesting against restrictions for Black voters.

1965



1436 Florence Cathedral

The Basilica di Santa Maria del Fiore in Florence, Italy, was consecrated (made holy) by Pope Eugenius IV. The huge brick dome of the cathedral was designed and built by Italian architect Filippo Brunelleschi and remains the largest ever built.

Born this day

1942 Aretha Franklin, Black American singer. Known as the Queen of Soul, this 18-time Grammy winner became the first woman to be honoured with a place in the Rock & Roll Hall of Fame.

1947 Elton John, British singer, songwriter, and performer. An LGBTQ+ icon, he is among the world's biggest pop stars and has sold more than 300 million records.

